

Android Expansion

Android gadgets of the future may be getting a LITTLE out of hand
<http://dgit.in/19WHPwr>



Saving the Smartwatch

An article emphasizing ways to can get the best out of the next generation of Smartwatches
<http://dgit.in/H6qYRI>

Camera Phones

other key areas. For starters, the camera app. Nokia Pro Cam, which is default on the 1020, takes almost a second and a half to ready itself for the first shot. We pressed the physical shutter button and the app takes about a second to load and then another half a second to sort of stabilize. This is a serious drawback for a phone that is being touted more as a camera than anything. If you would like to speed things up, you could just use the regular camera app, which performs a whole lot faster and does leverage the full resolution of the sensor, but it is Pro Cam that will allow you to use features such as lossless zoom and manual shooting controls that actually make the Lumia 1020 a photographer's phone.

In comparison the Sony Xperia Z1 flies. Not only does the phone go from standby to ready-to-shoot almost instantaneously, it can even fire off shots one after the other without any noticeable delay. What was incredibly disappointing about the Xperia Z1, which needs to be mentioned, is that the only way you can get the full 20 megapixel resolution out of this camera is if you shoot in manual mode. The logic and reasoning behind the resolution not being available in "iAuto" escapes us, making us feel as if Sony just might have dropped the ball. If you do get the Xperia Z1, make sure you change the dial to Manual (from iAuto).

The other two Lumia siblings do rather well, with a special note for the Lumia 920, which despite having older optics, does just as well as the Lumia 925. The LG G2 and the Samsung Galaxy Zoom were good too, especially given how we shoot with them. The Galaxy Zoom's forte is that it's an incredibly familiar shooting experience,



HTC One

given its form factor. The LG G2 has a strategically placed button on the back which somehow makes it convenient to press.

The HTC One and the iPhone 5 were impressive in their own right in our real world tests. Both fired off quick shots, but the iPhone 5 was visibly better than the HTC One in low light shooting, and just slightly faster to go from idle to shooting.

The one thing that we found slightly disappointing on the iPhone, the HTC One, the LG G2 and even the Samsung Galaxy Zoom was their need to fire up the camera using the icons on the screen. While the G2 and the Galaxy zoom do have physical buttons, they do not bring up the camera automatically. The HTC One and the iPhone don't have any physical buttons, but do come with icons that can be accessed directly from the home/lockscreen, but it's just not as fast as having a physical button.

If we talk pure image quality in the real world, the Lumia 1020 wins this too, but unfortunately, in the real world, there's more to performance than just pixel quality. The Pro Cam

app makes the Lumia 1020 slow, and since it's the only app that can actually leverage the mammoth sensor to the fullest, it's all the most frustrating. The Z1 breezes right ahead leaving even the Lumia 920 and the 925 in the dust (despite not even having optical image stabilization). The HTC One, despite the low resolution, does surprisingly well for its sensor,

and does produce good images, but the Lumias and the Xperia Z1 do better. The LG G2 and Samsung Galaxy Zoom are worth mentioning here. They seem to be at a slight disadvantage due to their small sensors, but very large pixel counts.

Video performance

Another bag of surprises came our way during our video testing. While we expected that the Lumia phones would top the roost, with their Carl Zeiss optics and image stabili-



Colour Rendition Sony Xperia Z1 left vs Lumia 920 right

zation, but it was actually quite a close call. The Lumias, and the Xperia Z1 were incredibly close in their video quality. While the Nokias came ahead in terms of audio quality, due to the "Rich Recording Technology" built into the phones. The Xperia Z1, however, stormed ahead in terms of low light autofocus. Overall, the Lumia 1020 was just a little bit better in retaining detail in shadows and highlights.

In the daytime, the Lumia 1020 charged right ahead of the competition. What's noteworthy is that pretty much all phones in the day time shoot some very impressive videos. However the Lumia 1020 had the best performance of them all, especially when it came to dynamic range. Where it did lose out a little was in terms of keeping up with the AF.

What we did find surprising was that the footage out of the HTC One was visibly lacking in edge sharpness, which is alright if your camera is static while filming, but can be pretty bad if you're trying to pan across a scene, or are trying to film someone running across the road for example. Still, the overall footage looked slightly soft, especially when put next to the iPhone 5.



Samsung Galaxy Zoom